

Shain D Souza

REGIONAL SALES LEADER | HEAD OF SALES | MENA & APAC

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PROFILE

Regional sales leader with eight years across MENA and APAC, spanning enterprise SaaS and luxury hospitality. Own a seven-market region end to end for a Y Combinator-backed event technology platform - headcount, targets, pricing, hiring and government relationships - leading a 15-person team carrying an annualised revenue run-rate of \$1.68M. Opened the UAE market from zero and built every commercial framework the region runs on: sales playbook, onboarding, performance management and compensation. Strategic advisor to the CEO on market entry and organisational decisions.

EXPERIENCE

Regional Manager | The Ticket Fairy DMCC

Oct 2021 - Present | Dubai, UAE

Y Combinator & 500 Global-backed event ticketing, marketing and payments SaaS. Angel investors include Steve Chen (YouTube), Steve Huffman (Reddit), Justin Kan and Kevin Lin (Twitch). Operating across MENA, APAC, UK, USA and Australia.

TEAM OWNERSHIP & PERFORMANCE

- Lead a **15-person direct-report team** - 7 business development, 2 social media, 2 graphic design, 2 content writers, 1 SEO specialist and 1 editorial lead - plus oversight of three specialist agencies.
- Carry an **annualised team revenue run-rate of \$1.68M**, set as a quota of 5 new logos and \$20K in platform revenue per BD executive per month, with acquisition targets varying by region.
- **Own hiring end to end**: define and justify open positions and headcount budget to finance and management, screen after HR, and hold the deciding vote in final panel interviews.
- **Own performance and exit decisions** - have taken multiple team members through structured PIPs to termination for sustained underperformance and for conduct, managing the process end to end with HR.
- Run weekly pipeline reviews, individual 1-on-1 coaching and quarterly performance cycles across both sales and non-sales functions, with KPI frameworks covering content output and organic traffic growth.

BUILDING THE COMMERCIAL FUNCTION

- **Built every core framework from scratch** where none existed: sales playbook, onboarding programme, performance management structure and commission model.
- **Architected the full RevOps stack** - HubSpot CRM, Clay, ClickUp - establishing pipeline visibility and forecasting discipline across all regions.
- Built AI-powered outbound automation using Clay and n8n, improving lead qualification and reducing customer acquisition cost.
- Direct a B2B content and SEO operation driving inbound pipeline, alongside a B2C function promoting client events to end consumers.

REGIONAL OWNERSHIP & STRATEGY

- **Strategic advisor to the CEO** on market entry, pricing, product priorities and organisational structure; drive quarterly planning and regional budget cycles.
- **Opened the UAE market personally** - first commercial presence, first anchor clients, first pricing framework.
- **Primary government and regulatory liaison** - Department of Economy & Tourism relationship and sole owner of UAE licensing, compliance and contracting.
- Set UAE pricing strategy and negotiate directly with payment processors to improve platform unit economics.
- Diagnosed high self-signup abandonment and redeployed the sales team onto dormant account conversion - **50% uplift in self-signups going live**.

PARTNERSHIPS & DEAL ENABLEMENT

- **Co-negotiated a capital partnership** giving clients access to working capital for event operating costs ahead of ticket revenue - removing the primary cash-flow barrier to signing.
- Converted the partnership into a commercial differentiator: **7 clients signed, generating \$2M in ticket sales over two years**.
- Structured insurance and payment processing partnerships that improved client economics and platform unit economics on every deal signed in the region.

ENTERPRISE SALES DELIVERED

- **\$5M+ in gross ticket value** processed by enterprise accounts acquired personally, through C-level and founder-level engagement across seven markets.
- Hold executive relationships across the platform's largest global accounts, including **Twitch, EDC Las Vegas (official afterparties) and StarLadder**.
- Led teams above target: **£300K+ delivered by the UK team; 140+ new clients acquired in India** including a **₹20M white-label agreement**.
- **90% client retention** across multi-year enterprise accounts through structured QBRs and executive relationship management.
- Negotiate bespoke commercial terms, pricing and technical requirements with organisations across the UAE, UK, USA, India, Singapore, Indonesia and Australia.

Business Development Team Lead | Green World Safety & Security Consultancy

Feb 2020 - Sep 2021 | Dubai, UAE

B2B SaaS - cloud LMS and certification platform for safety and compliance training, sold into petroleum, manufacturing and industrial enterprises.

- **Promoted to Team Lead within six months** after delivering the highest monthly revenue in the business for three consecutive months - a senior individual contributor role owning the enterprise segment.
- Sold cloud LMS licences and certification programmes to blue-chip industrial enterprises including **Bharat Petroleum (BPCL), Aditya Birla Group, Siemens and Tata**.
- Structured multi-year licence agreements and committed enrolment volumes across accredited programmes - NEBOSH IGC and IDip, OSHA, first aid and industrial safety certifications - blending SaaS licensing with instructor-led delivery.
- Ran full enterprise cycles into HSE directors, L&D heads and procurement, navigating multi-stakeholder approval in petroleum, manufacturing and industrial sectors.
- Opened new verticals and delivered a **20% year-on-year increase in enterprise client acquisition**.
- Built the structured pipeline and outreach cadences later adopted across the team, improving lead-to-opportunity conversion.

Sales & Marketing Executive | Taj Hotels (IHCL)

May 2018 - Nov 2019 | Goa, India

Taj Holiday Village Resort & Spa, Goa (142 keys) - IHCL, India's leading luxury hotel group.

- Managed **20 concurrent B2B accounts** spanning national corporates, UHNW clients, travel trade and OTAs - including Thomas Cook and Cox & Kings.
- Negotiated guaranteed room-night contracts valued at **₹1M+ each**, plus preferential corporate rate agreements covering long-stay project and executive travel.
- Drove recurring occupancy through long-term partnership agreements rather than transactional bookings, building repeat corporate demand into the resort's base business.
- Sold and coordinated conference, MICE and event business across a 142-key luxury resort, working with F&B, rooms and events teams on delivery.
- Ran segmentation-led marketing campaigns using customer behavioural analytics to target high-value corporate and leisure segments.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership: Team leadership & scaling · Hiring and headcount planning · Performance management & PIPs · Coaching · Compensation design · Agency management

Commercial: Enterprise SaaS sales · C-level negotiation · Go-to-market & market entry · Pricing strategy · Forecasting · Retention & QBRs

Operations: Government & regulatory liaison (DET) · Contract negotiation & compliance · Quarterly planning · Budget planning · Product collaboration

Technology: HubSpot · Pipedrive · Clay · Sales Navigator · n8n · Zapier · ClickUp · Google Analytics · Ahrefs · SEMrush

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Business Administration, Sales & Marketing | Goa University

2015 - 2018

Inbound Sales Certification · HubSpot Academy

Languages: English (fluent) · Hindi (fluent) · Konkani (native)